

FULL NAME: _____

BLOCK: _____

Inverse Variation Applications + DOK-3 Performance Task

Lesson 4-1 · Period 2 · Student Packet

OBJECTIVES

Math Objective	Apply inverse variation to real-world contexts (wavelength, gas pressure, travel distance), and distinguish DIRECT variation ($y = kx$) from INVERSE variation ($xy = k$) inside a single multi-part problem.
Language Objective	Students will use the frame “This is ___ variation because as ___, ___ proportionally.” to justify whether a relationship is direct or inverse.
Essential Understanding	Not every covariation is inverse variation. Direct variation has a constant RATIO ($y/x = k$); inverse variation has a constant PRODUCT ($xy = k$). A single scenario can contain BOTH types across different variable pairs.

TOPIC GOALS / ESSENTIAL QUESTION / MATERIALS

Topic Goals	Students model 4 contextual inverse-variation problems, then tackle a Performance Task (Ramón’s road trip) that embeds direct and inverse variation in one scenario. Every item is Savvas-sourced.
Essential Question	How does inverse variation model real-world relationships, and how is it different from direct variation?
Materials	Pencils; student packet; calculator. No Chromebooks required.

LAUNCH — Inverse Variation in Context (teacher models Example 3)

[BOOK] APPLICATION RULES (keep printed on your page)

- To model an inverse variation in context:
 - Identify the two varying quantities and their constant product k .
 - Compute k from one given pair: $k = (\text{quantity 1}) \times (\text{quantity 2})$.
 - Write the equation: $y = k/x$ (or rename variables to fit the context).
 - Solve for the unknown quantity.
- Example (Savvas Ex 3, bouzouki): string length s varies inversely with frequency f .
 26-inch string $\rightarrow 329.63$ cycles/sec $\rightarrow k = 26 \times 329.63 = 8,570.38$.
 New length 13 inches $\rightarrow f = 8,570.38/13 = 659.26$ cycles/sec.

[WARN] DIRECT vs INVERSE (both appear in today’s DOK-3!)

DIRECT: $y = kx \rightarrow y/x$ is constant. As x increases, y INCREASES proportionally.

INVERSE: $y = k/x$ ($xy = k$). As x increases, y DECREASES proportionally.

Test: compute y/x (direct) AND xy (inverse). Whichever is constant tells you the relationship.

EXPLORE — Think-Pair-Share (33 min)

Work with a partner. Move in order. Practice #26 (Ramón) is the big one — plan ~15 min for it.

Bank-item labels (in order):

1. Try It 3 — Ice cube melting
2. Practice #12 — HOT: inverse SQUARE variation
3. Practice #17 — Radio wavelength (graph)
4. Practice #23 — Boyle's Law (volleyball vs basketball)
5. Practice #26 [STAR] PERFORMANCE TASK · Ramón's road trip

Try It 3 — Ice cube melting

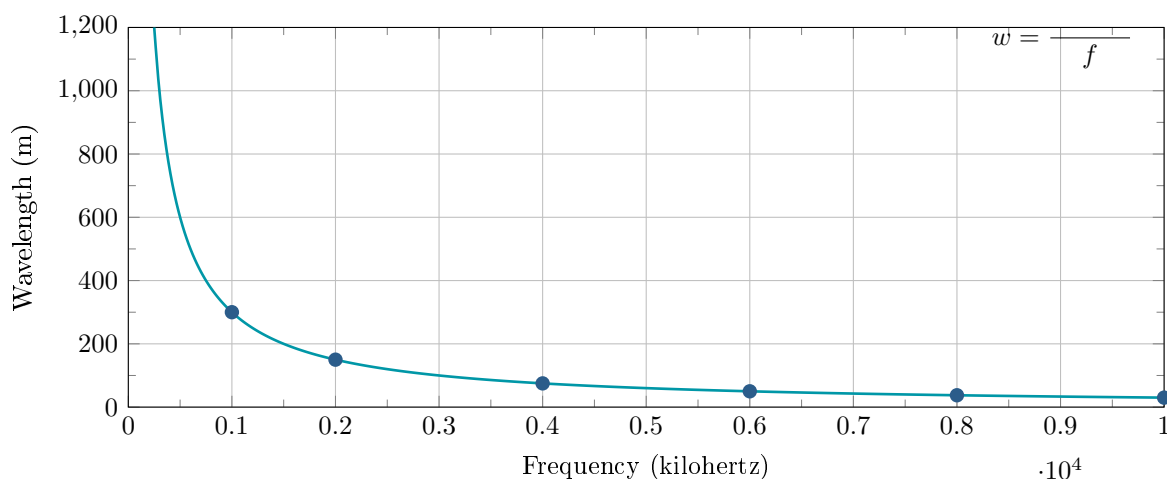
Try It 3. The amount of time it takes for an ice cube to melt varies inversely with the air temperature in degrees Celsius. At 20°C , the ice will melt in 20 minutes. How long will it take the ice to melt if the temperature is 30°C ?

Practice #12 — HOT: inverse SQUARE variation

12. Higher Order Thinking: Suppose y varies inversely as the square of x . If x is multiplied by 4, what is true for the value of y ?

Practice #17 — Radio wavelength (graph)

17. The wavelength, w , of a radio wave varies inversely to its frequency, f , as shown in the graph. The graph shows w (m) on the y-axis from 0 to 1200, and f (kilohertz) on the x-axis from 0 to 10000, with the curve $w = k/f$ passing through data points including (1000, 300), (2000, 150), (4000, 75), (6000, 50), (8000, 37.5), (10000, 30). A radio wave with a frequency of 1,000 kilohertz has a length of 300 m. What is the frequency when the wavelength is 375 m?



Practice #23 — Boyle's Law (volleyball vs basketball)

23. Model With Mathematics: Boyle's Law states that the pressure exerted by fixed quantity of a gas, P , varies inversely with the volume the gas occupies, V , assuming constant temperature. The volume and air pressure of a volleyball are 300 in^3 and 4.5 psi. The volume and air pressure of a basketball are 415 in^3 and 8 psi. How much smaller would the volleyball have to be to be equal the air pressure

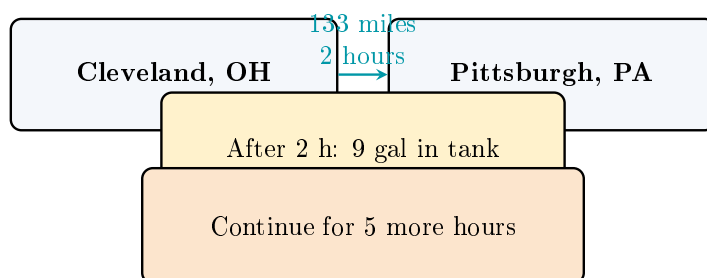
of the basketball?

Practice #26 [STAR] PERFORMANCE TASK · Ramón's road trip

26. Performance Task. Suppose Ramón takes a road trip. He starts from his home in the suburbs of Cleveland, OH and travels to Pittsburgh, PA to visit his aunt and uncle.

Part A: The distance Ramón drives from Cleveland to Pittsburgh is 133 miles. The trip takes him 2 hours. The distance d in miles that Ramón drives varies directly with the amount of time t in hours he spends driving. Write the equation of the direct variation. Use the given relationship and the equation to find the number of miles Ramón would travel if he continues on for 5 more hours.

Part B: The amount of gas in Ramón's car is 9 gal after he drives for 2 h. The amount of gas g in gallons in his tank varies inversely with the amount of time t in hours he spends driving. Write the equation of the inverse variation. Use the given relationship and the equation to find the number of gallons in Ramón's tank after 5 more hours of driving.



SHARE / SUMMARY (5 min)

Sentence frames

Pair share (Ramón task): “Part A is ___ variation because distance and time have a constant RATIO of _____. Part B is ___ variation because gas and time have a constant PRODUCT of _____.”

Whole class: one pair reads the contrast. Class signals thumbs up/sideways.

[SEARCH] BRIDGE TO P3 (Wednesday)

Tomorrow we graph the RECIPROCAL FUNCTION $y = 1/x$ and its translations. Watch for: the graph of inverse variation has asymptotes and a specific shape — a hyperbola. You’ve been drawing them already; we’ll name the features.

EXIT

Today I learned that
The biggest trap in Ramón's task was
I distinguish direct from inverse variation by

OPTIONAL REINFORCEMENT (not collected)

If you finish Explore early. #25 is a fast SAT-style question that stretches the inverse-variation idea.

Optional #1 (Savvas Practice, SAT/ACT style)

25. SAT/ACT. In a given set of experiments, t and w always vary inversely. When $t = 0.4$ seconds, $w = 172.8$ grams. How much time has passed when $w = 14.4$ grams?

- A. 2.4 s
- B. 4.8 s
- C. 27.648 s
- D. 995.328 s